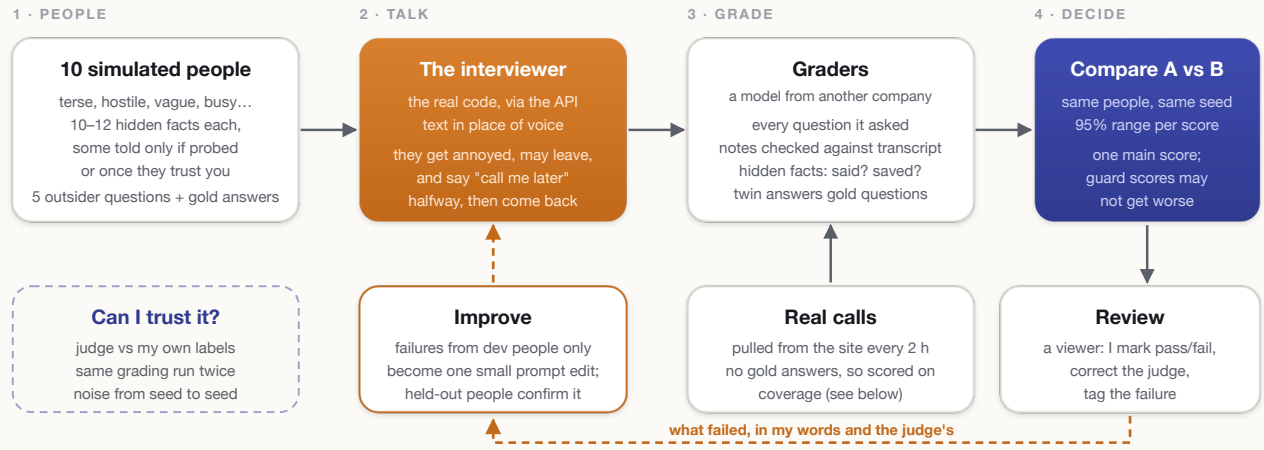
VIVEN AI · EVAL HARNESS · NOVEMBER 2026

How I know a change made the interviewer better

Your question on the call: if a prompt change takes capture from 50% to 70%, how do I know nothing else broke, that people didn't leave or drift off, and how would I know when everything has been captured? The harness answers that by running the real interviewer against simulated people whose knowledge I wrote down in advance.



One loop: run, grade, compare, read the failures, change one thing, run again. Judge calls are cached, so regrading old runs costs nothing.

THE THREE THINGS IT MEASURES

How much was captured

"you captured 50%… now 70%"

Share of each person's hidden facts they actually said, and share that reached the notes, with vital facts counted double. Then the twin test: another model answers the gold questions from the notes alone, and the judge marks it right, partly right, wrong or "don't know".

What else broke

"did people drop off, go off on a tangent?"

Guard scores that may not get worse: walked out, peak annoyance, re-asking, two questions at once, pressing after pushback, praise, repeating their answer back, notes the transcript doesn't support, twin answers that were made up.

Whether to trust the numbers

"are you evaluating the right things?"

The judge is checked against my labels (catches the failure, stays quiet when there isn't one), graded twice to see how often labels flip, and run on two seeds to find the smallest change these ten people can show.

A REAL ROUND: BASE VS. ONE PROMPT EDIT

5 dev people × 2 seeds, graded blind	base	edit
Hidden facts they said	0.29	**0.32**
Hidden facts saved in notes	0.29	**0.32**
Areas of their life covered	2.0	**2.8**
Filler lines per conversation	7.8	**6.9**
Re-asks per conversation	0.2	**0.5**

The edit: move on once a topic has their view and one real case. It was merged, but the guard caught re-asks going up, and one person (Ray) got worse. That is the "what else broke" question answered with numbers.

FOR REAL PEOPLE, AND WHAT'S NOT DONE

- **Real calls have no answer key.** So the judge writes the questions people would ask this person's twin, answers them from the notes, and checks each answer against everything they said. On simulated people I can check that this tracks the gold score.
- **Held-out people** are set aside for confirming edits, but haven't been run yet: the credit ran out.
- **My hand labels** for checking the judge are the next step. The tooling is built.
- **Tangents** are tested by people who drift (Meera wanders to her students), not by a score of their own yet.